

PLAGUE ZOMBIES

We present a new kind of undead for 5e: plague zombies built for medieval apocalypse play.

Plague Zombies is a monster supplement that reimagines the traditional zombie as a relentless, infectious horror designed for survival campaigns, siege scenarios, and collapsing kingdoms. These are not shambling hit point sacks. They are battlefield problems that demand precision, discipline, and hard choices.

This product introduces a unified mechanical identity for plague zombies:

- They do not die unless destroyed by a headshot.
- Dropping them to 0 hit points is not enough.
- They grapple.
- They bite.
- They infect.
- They turn the fallen into more of their kind.

Combat becomes tactical. Players must decide when to risk a called headshot, when to disengage, and when to spend precious magic curing infection. Radiant damage matters. Critical hits matter. Positioning matters.

They are simple fighters. They grab. They bite. They spread.

THE PLAGUE

A living creature struck by a plague zombie's Bite must succeed on a **DC 12 Constitution saving throw** or become infected. An infected creature remains alive but carries the plague within its body. After **1d4 days**, the infection completes its course: the creature dies and rises as a plague zombie immediately. The infection can be cured only by lesser restoration, greater restoration, or wish cast before transformation occurs.

If an infected creature dies before the plague completes its natural course, the transformation accelerates. The corpse rises as a plague zombie in 10d6 minutes.

Plague Zombies are not meant to replace standard undead in heroic fantasy. They are intended for darker tables, where containment may fail and every battlefield wound carries long-term consequences.

Geography, origin, and cause of the plague are intentionally undefined. The outbreak could be divine judgment, necromantic experimentation, extraplanar corruption, or mundane disease amplified by magic. Whether the world is in early outbreak or full collapse is left entirely in the GM's hands.

Plague Zombies are not variants. They are a system.

PLAGUE ZOMBIE SPECIES

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Plague Zombie	1/2	The base infection vector: slow, relentless, grappling dead that only fall to head destruction.
Zombie Dwarf	1/2	Stubborn corpse that resists forced movement and anchors chokepoints with grim endurance.
Zombie Elf	1/2	Faster, more agile undead that close distance quickly before attempting the killing bite.
Zombie Halfling	1/2	Small and swarming, slipping through lines to drag victims down from below.
Zombie Gnome	1/2	Harder to mentally influence, lingering fragments of will resisting magical control.
Zombie Dragonborn	1	Carries a remnant breath weapon that vents necrotic corruption across clustered defenders.
Zombie Lizardfolk	1	Swamp-hardened corpse with a vicious bite and resistance to environmental hardship.
Zombie Orc	1	Brutal and forceful, overwhelming prey with raw strength before the bite lands.
Zombie Merfolk	1/2	Aquatic drowner that drags victims beneath the surface before infecting them.
Zombie Ratfolk	1/2	Sewer-born carrier that thrives in numbers and spreads plague through urban collapse.
Zombie Goblin	1/2	Quick and opportunistic, darting in to grapple isolated targets.
Zombie Hobgoblin	1	Formation-minded undead that hold lines even in death.
Zombie Bugbear	2	Long-limbed ambusher that reaches past shields to seize prey.
Zombie Gnoll	1	Frenzied corpse driven by predatory instinct and infectious hunger.
Zombie Ogre	3	Massive grappler capable of dragging armored warriors to the ground with ease.
Zombie Minotaur	3	Charging brute that breaks defensive lines before attempting to feed.
Zombie Troll	5	Towering horror whose sheer resilience makes head destruction a desperate priority.
Zombie Hill Giant	6	Siege-scale undead that turns battlefield collapse into mass infection.

Bringing the zombie apocalypse to your table.

PLAGUE ZOMBIE

Medium undead, unaligned

Armor Class 9

Hit Points 18 (4d8)

Speed 20 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	9 (–1)	10 (+0)	4 (–3)	6 (–2)	5 (–3)

Condition Immunities poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 8

Languages None

Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Headshot Only. When making a melee or ranged weapon attack against this zombie, a creature may declare a headshot before rolling the attack. This zombie's AC increases by 3 against that attack. If a headshot reduces this zombie to 0 hit points, it is destroyed. Radiant damage and critical hits automatically count as headshots.

Undead Persistence. If this zombie is reduced to 0 hit points by an attack that was not a headshot, it instead drops to 1 hit point.

Pack Hunger. This zombie has advantage on attack rolls against a creature if at least one other plague zombie is within 5 feet of the target and isn't incapacitated.

Plague Infection. A living creature struck by this zombie's Bite must succeed on a DC 12 Constitution saving throw or become infected. An infected creature remains alive but carries the plague within its body. After 1d4 days, the infection completes its course: the creature dies and rises as a plague zombie immediately. The infection can be cured only by *lesser restoration*, *greater restoration*, or *wish* cast before the transformation occurs. If an infected creature dies before the plague completes its natural course, the transformation accelerates. The corpse rises as a plague zombie in 10d6 minutes.

ACTIONS:

Grapple. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one Medium or smaller creature. *Hit:* The target is grappled (escape DC 12). Until this grapple ends, this zombie can't grapple another creature. A grappled creature can use its action to escape.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature grappled by this or another zombie. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) piercing damage, DC 12 Con save or become infected.

- Weak alone; lethal in groups. Use in clusters of 3+.
- Headshot rule should be explained clearly before first combat.
- Infection creates long-term tension, not just encounter danger.
- Best used in waves, not as single monsters.



PLAGUE ZOMBIE HALFLING

Small undead, unaligned

Armor Class 11

Hit Points 14 (3d8)

Speed 15 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)	4 (–3)	6 (–2)	5 (–3)

Condition Immunities poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 8

Languages None

Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Headshot Only. When making a melee or ranged weapon attack against this zombie, a creature may declare a headshot before rolling the attack. This zombie's AC increases by 3 against that attack. If a headshot reduces this zombie to 0 hit points, it is destroyed. Radiant damage and critical hits automatically count as headshots.

Undead Persistence. If this zombie is reduced to 0 hit points by an attack that was not a headshot, it instead drops to 1 hit point.

Pack Hunger. This zombie has advantage on attack rolls against a creature if at least one other plague zombie is within 5 feet of the target and isn't incapacitated.

Underfoot Shambler. This zombie can move through the space of a Medium or larger creature. It can't end its turn in another creature's space.

Plague Infection. A living creature struck by this zombie's Bite must succeed on a DC 12 Constitution saving throw or become infected. An infected creature remains alive but carries the plague within its body. After 1d4 days, the infection completes its course: the creature dies and rises as a plague zombie immediately. The infection can be cured only by *lesser restoration*, *greater restoration*, or *wish* cast before the transformation occurs. If an infected creature dies before the plague completes its natural course, the transformation accelerates. The corpse rises as a plague zombie in 10d6 minutes.

ACTIONS:

Grapple. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one Medium or smaller creature. *Hit:* The target is grappled (escape DC 11). Until this grapple ends, this zombie can't grapple another creature. A grappled creature can use its action to escape.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature grappled by this or another zombie. *Hit:* 5 (1d8 + 1) piercing damage, DC 12 Con save or become infected.

- Extremely dangerous indoors due to Underfoot Shambler.
- 15 ft speed makes it a creeping threat rather than a chaser.
- Best used in cramped town or cellar encounters.
- Swarm behavior makes them panic-inducing.



PLAGUE ZOMBIE GOBLIN

Small undead, unaligned

Armor Class 10

Hit Points 15 (3d8 + 2)

Speed 15 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	10 (+0)	11 (+0)	4 (–3)	6 (–2)	5 (–3)

Condition Immunities poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 8

Languages None

Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Headshot Only. When making a melee or ranged weapon attack against this zombie, a creature may declare a headshot before rolling the attack. This zombie's AC increases by 3 against that attack. If a headshot reduces this zombie to 0 hit points, it is destroyed. Radiant damage and critical hits automatically count as headshots.

Undead Persistence. If this zombie is reduced to 0 hit points by an attack that was not a headshot, it instead drops to 1 hit point.

Pack Hunger. This zombie has advantage on attack rolls against a creature if at least one other plague zombie is within 5 feet of the target and isn't incapacitated.

Feral Scramble. When this zombie reduces a creature to 0 hit points, it can immediately move up to half its speed toward another creature it can see.

Plague Infection. A living creature struck by this zombie's Bite must succeed on a DC 12 Constitution saving throw or become infected. An infected creature remains alive but carries the plague within its body. After 1d4 days, the infection completes its course: the creature dies and rises as a plague zombie immediately. The infection can be cured only by *lesser restoration*, *greater restoration*, or *wish* cast before the transformation occurs. If an infected creature dies before the plague completes its natural course, the transformation accelerates. The corpse rises as a plague zombie in 10d6 minutes.

ACTIONS:

Grapple. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one Medium or smaller creature. *Hit:* The target is grappled (escape DC 12). Until this grapple ends, this zombie can't grapple another creature. A grappled creature can use its action to escape.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature grappled by this or another zombie. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) piercing damage, DC 12 Con save or become infected.

- Aggressive chaining behavior keeps pressure on the party.
- Good for urban riots or dungeon infestations.
- Slightly stronger than ratfolk but still fragile.
- Best used in packs of 4+.



PLAGUE ZOMBIE MINOTAUR

Large undead, unaligned

Armor Class 9

Hit Points 90 (12d10 + 24)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	8 (–1)	15 (+2)	4 (–3)	6 (–2)	5 (–3)

Condition Immunities poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 8

Languages None

Challenge 3 (700 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Headshot Only. When making a melee or ranged weapon attack against this zombie, a creature may declare a headshot before rolling the attack. This zombie's AC increases by 3 against that attack. If a headshot reduces this zombie to 0 hit points, it is destroyed. Radiant damage and critical hits automatically count as headshots.

Undead Persistence. If this zombie is reduced to 0 hit points by an attack that was not a headshot, it instead drops to 1 hit point.

Pack Hunger. This zombie has advantage on attack rolls against a creature if at least one other plague zombie is within 5 feet of the target and isn't incapacitated.

Plague Infection. A living creature struck by this zombie's Bite must succeed on a DC 12 Constitution saving throw or become infected. An infected creature remains alive but carries the plague within its body. After 1d4 days, the infection completes its course: the creature dies and rises as a plague zombie immediately. The infection can be cured only by *lesser restoration*, *greater restoration*, or *wish* cast before the transformation occurs. If an infected creature dies before the plague completes its natural course, the transformation accelerates. The corpse rises as a plague zombie in 10d6 minutes.

ACTIONS:

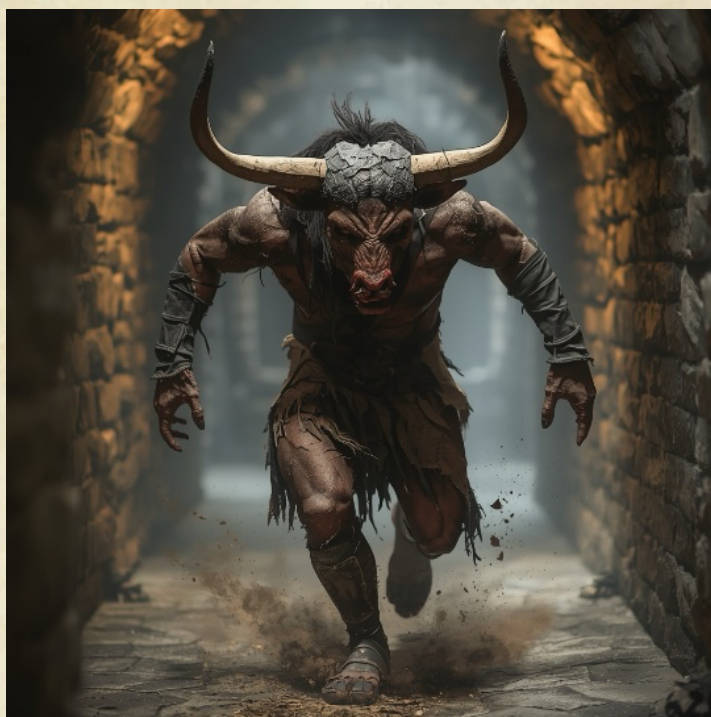
Grapple. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one Large or smaller creature. *Hit:* The target is grappled (escape DC 15). Until this grapple ends, this zombie can't grapple another creature. A grappled creature can use its action to escape.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature grappled by this or another zombie. *Hit:* 10 (1d10 + 5) piercing damage, DC 12 Con save or become infected.

BONUS ACTIONS:

Trampling Charge. If this zombie moves at least 20 feet straight toward a creature and then hits it with a Grapple on the same turn, the target must succeed on a DC 15 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone. If the target is knocked prone, this zombie can make a Bite attack against it as a bonus action.

- Charge + knockdown creates explosive openings.
- Ideal in long corridors or arena-style spaces.
- Bonus bite after knockdown increases lethality.
- Use as dungeon outbreak boss.



COMPATIBLE CONTENT

The apocalypse can break out on any [Fantasy Map](#).

[Ratfolk](#) are a new monster clan.

LEGAL

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